

Abbott Laboratories

Recommendation **BUY** ★★★★★

Price **USD 90.87** [as of market close Oct 13, 2023] **12-Mo. Target Price** **USD 130.00** **Report Currency** **USD** **Investment Style** **Large-Cap Blend**

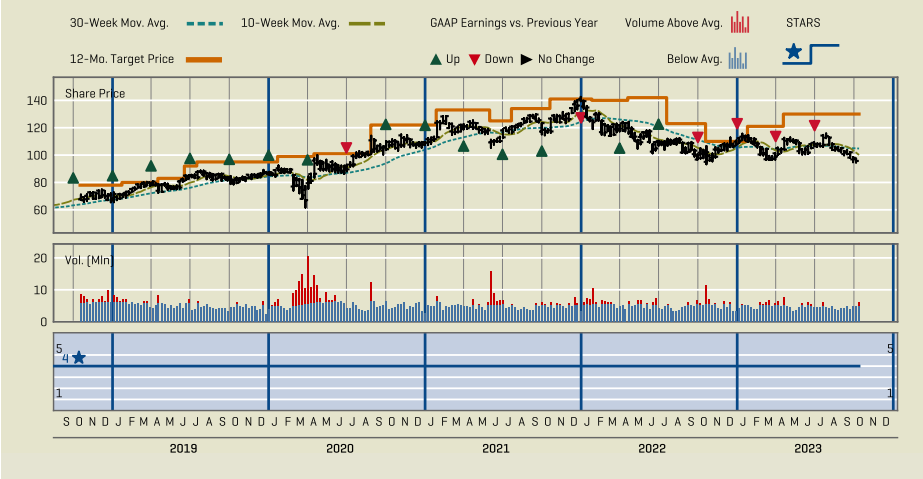
Equity Analyst **Paige Meyer**

GICS Sector Health Care
Sub-Industry Health Care Equipment

Summary Abbott Laboratories is a diversified health care products company focused on nutritional products, diagnostics, generic drugs, and medical devices.

Key Stock Statistics [Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports]							
52-Wk Range	USD 115.83 - 89.67	Oper.EPS2023E	USD 4.40	Market Capitalization[B]	USD 157.69	Beta	0.68
Trailing 12-Month EPS	USD 4.29	Oper.EPS2024E	USD 4.63	Yield [%]	2.24	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	NM
Trailing 12-Month P/E	21.18	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	20.65	Dividend Rate/Share	USD 2.04	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	B+
USD 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	14,254.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	1,735.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	USD 2.04	Institutional Ownership [%]	76.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Paige Meyer** on Jul 20, 2023 04:36 PM ET, when the stock traded at **USD 111.83**.

Highlights

- ▶ We expect 2023 total sales to contract 9% to \$39.6 billion, following growth of 1% in 2022. Sales in 2021 saw a huge boost from the surge in demand for Covid-19 tests, which brought in revenue of approximately \$7.7 billion for ABT, or 18% of total sales. We expect Covid-19 sales will drop to \$1.4 billion in 2023 [vs. \$8.4 billion in 2022], as demand wanes following the end of the public health emergency. We see total sales returning to 5% growth in 2024 with acceleration in key franchises such as Alinity [Diagnostic systems], Freestyle Libre [Diabetes], and MitraClip [Heart].
- ▶ The pandemic upset ABT's high growth segments: medical devices and non-Covid-19 diagnostics. In 2023, we anticipate continued recovery in physician visits and elective procedure volumes driving growth in ABT's non-Covid-19-related businesses, allowing ABT to limit its sales decline as Covid-19 testing demand tapers. Stripping the impacts of Covid-19 sales and FX, we forecast 2023 organic sales growth in the high-single digits.
- ▶ We forecast a 18% Y/Y EPS drop for ABT in 2023, but see record EPS of \$5.58 by 2026 as ABT's stand-out glucose monitoring technology [Freestyle Libre] gains market share.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- ▶ We think shares of ABT will outperform the market and peers over the long term, driven by its highly innovative diversified health care businesses allowing for growing market share over time, a strong financial position, and a consistently growing dividend. In 2023, we expect ABT sales will fall as Covid-19 testing demand tapers off post-pandemic. But in the long run, we think shares have attractive upside potential due to ABT's sustainable earnings growth trend driven by a plethora of innovative recent and upcoming offerings [e.g., Freestyle Libre 3 and structural heart products] across all operating segments. We also anticipate strong growth in the Diabetes Care medical device market.
- ▶ Risks to our view include faster-than-expected shrinkage in Covid test sales, a recurrence of problems related to baby formula production, high cost inflation compressing margins, weak execution on new or key product commercialization, regulatory delays, and unfavorable currency movements.
- ▶ Our 12-month target of \$130 is 28.1x our 2024 EPS estimate, above ABT's five-year forward P/E average due to our view of ABT's superior long-term growth trajectory, but below peak levels given the Covid testing slowdown.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW	MEDIUM	HIGH
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ABT has strong positions in key health care product categories and has a robust product pipeline. The company recently has a strong balance sheet and a history of robust free cash flow generation. Given the company's financial stability, commitment to R&D investment, and expansive product portfolio, we think that ABT has a low operational risk.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 10,032	E 10,463	E 10,567	E 10,947	E 42,009
2023	9,747	9,978	E 9,685	E 10,198	E 39,608
2022	11,895	11,257	10,410	10,091	43,653
2021	10,456	10,223	10,928	11,468	43,075
2020	7,726	7,328	8,853	10,701	34,608
2019	7,535	7,979	8,076	8,314	31,904

Earnings Per Share (USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 1.06	E 1.14	E 1.17	E 1.25	E 4.63
2023	1.03	1.08	E 1.10	E 1.19	E 4.40
2022	1.73	1.43	1.15	1.03	5.34
2021	1.32	1.17	1.40	1.32	5.21
2020	0.65	0.57	0.98	1.45	3.65
2019	0.63	0.82	0.84	0.95	3.24

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [USD]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.5100	Sep 21	Oct 12	Oct 13	Nov 15 '23
0.5100	Jun 09	Jul 13	Jul 14	Aug 15 '23
0.5100	Feb 17	Apr 13	Apr 14	May 15 '23
0.5100	Dec 09	Jan 12	Jan 13	Feb 15 '23

Dividends have been paid since 1971 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.



Abbott Laboratories

Business Summary Jul 20, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW. Abbott Laboratories (ABT) operates in four reportable segments: established pharmaceutical products (branded generics), diagnostic products, nutritional products, and medical devices. Combined, these segments generated \$43.7 billion in sales in 2022, with 17.1% coming from nutrition, 38.0% from diagnostics, 11.3% from established pharmaceuticals, and 33.6% from medical devices. These diverse operations are largely a result of strategic acquisitions made over the years, as well as from internal research and development (R&D) programs. ABT commands leading market positions for many of the products that it sells.

Nutritional Products include a broad line of pediatric and adult nutritional products manufactured, marketed, and sold worldwide. These products include various forms of prepared infant formula such as Similac, adult and other pediatric nutritional products such as Ensure, nutritional products used in enteral feeding such as Jevity, and nutritional brands such as Zone Perfect bars. Competitive factors in this segment include consumer advertising, formulation, packaging, scientific innovation, price, retail distribution, and availability of product forms. A significant aspect of competition is the search for ingredient innovations. ABT announced voluntary recalls of formulas in February 2022 due to detected pathogens (Cronobacter sakazakii) in its routine testing at its Sturgis, Michigan, facility, though doesn't anticipate a material impact to earnings. On July 1, Abbott restarted partial production at the facility beginning with its specialty formula EleCare and metabolic formulas. Subsequently, Abbott restarted Similac production.

Diagnostics Products include a broad line of diagnostic systems and tests (including Covid-19 tests) manufactured, marketed, and sold worldwide. Principal products in this segment include molecular diagnostics systems, point of care systems, rapid diagnostics systems, informatics, and automation solutions for use in laboratories, and core laboratory systems in the areas of immunoassay, clinical chemistry, hematology, and transfusion. ABT's latest family of core laboratory systems are branded as Alinity. Products in this segment are subject to competition in technological innovation, price, convenience of use, service, instrument warranty provisions, product performance, laboratory efficiency, long-term supply contracts, and product potential for overall cost-effectiveness and productivity gains.

The Established Pharmaceuticals segment's products include a broad line of branded generic pharmaceuticals manufactured worldwide and marketed and sold outside the U.S. in emerging markets. These products are generally sold directly to wholesalers, distributors, government agencies, health care facilities, pharmacies, and independent retailers from Abbott-owned distribution centers and public warehouses, depending on the market served. ABT's growth strategy for this business has been to increase the breadth of product offerings by launching new and improved formulations and registering products across multiple geographic regions. Competition in this segment is generally from other health care and pharmaceutical companies.

The Medical Devices segment includes a broad line of rhythm management, electrophysiology, heart failure, vascular, and structural heart devices for the treatment of cardiovascular diseases, and diabetes care products for diabetics, as well as neuromodulation devices for the management of chronic pain and movement disorders. Medical devices are manufactured, marketed, and sold worldwide. Products in this segment are subject to competition in technological innovation, price, convenience of use, service, product performance, long-term supply contracts, and product potential for overall cost-effectiveness and productivity gains. Some products in this segment can be subject to rapid product obsolescence or regulatory changes.

IMPACT OF MAJOR DEVELOPMENTS. ABT did not make any major acquisitions from 2019 through 2022, though this is following two major acquisitions in 2017. Although ABT is in a good position to make a major acquisition, we expect the company to focus on its numerous internal growth opportunities and tuck-in acquisitions. ABT's two major acquisitions in 2017 were Alere, a leading firm in point-of-care diagnostics, on October 3, 2017, for \$4.5 billion in cash and St. Jude Medical (STJ), a leader in cardiac and neuromodulation devices, on January 4, 2017, for \$23.6 billion in total. We believe the combination of STJ and ABT enabled ABT to become a leader in cardiovascular care. In 2017, ABT also completed the sale of Abbott Medical Optics, its vision care business, to Johnson & Johnson for \$4.3 billion.

FINANCIAL TRENDS. ABT's revenue grew 1.3% year-over-year to \$43.7 billion in 2022, following a strong 2021 due to Covid-19 test sales. In 2022, ABT spent \$2.89 billion (6.6% of revenue) on research and development (R&D), up slightly relative to revenue from \$2.63 billion (6.1% of revenue) in 2021. ABT's normalized diluted EPS growth was (0.8%) in 2022, down considerably from the unique 58.2% surge achieved in 2021. As of December 31, 2022, ABT had an easily manageable level of debt, in our opinion. Net debt to capital was 12.7% and net debt to trailing-12-month EBITDA was 0.6x.

Corporate information

Investor contact N/A [224 667 6100]	
Office 100 Abbott Park Road, Abbott Park, North Chicago, Illinois, 60064-6400	
Telephone 224 667 6100	
Fax N/A	
Website www.abbott.com	
Officers	
Chairman of the Board, President & CEO R. B. Ford	Executive VP, General Counsel & Secretary H. L. Allen
CFO & Senior VP of Finance P. P. Boudreau	
Board Members	
C. L. Babineaux-Fontenot	M. G. O'Grady
D. J. Starks	N. McKinstry
D. W. McDew	P. P. Gonzalez
J. G. Stratton	R. B. Ford
M. A. Kumbier	R. J. Alpern
M. F. Roman	S. E. Blount
Domicile Illinois	Auditor Ernst & Young LLP
Founded 1888	
Employees 115,000	
Stockholders 33,984	

Abbott Laboratories

Quantitative Evaluations					
Fair Value Rank	1	2	3	4	5
	LOWEST		HIGHEST		
	Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued (1) to most undervalued (5).				
Fair Value Calculation	USD 76.98	Analysis of the stock's current worth, based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model suggests that ABT is overvalued by USD 13.89 or 15.29%			
Volatility	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH
Technical Evaluation	BULLISH	Since April, 2023, the technical indicators for ABT have been BULLISH"			
Insider Activity	UNFAVORABLE		NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE

Expanded Ratio Analysis				
	2022	2021	2020	2019
Price/Sales	4.44	5.85	5.65	4.85
Price/EBITDA	16.00	19.74	21.75	19.91
Price/Pretax Income	23.32	30.66	39.36	37.94
P/E Ratio	20.56	27.01	30.00	26.81
Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	1,764.00	1,789.00	1,786.00	1,781.00
Figures based on fiscal year-end price				

Key Growth Rates and Averages			
Past Growth Rate [%]	1 Year	3 Years	5 Years
Net Income	NM	23.43	70.80
Sales	1.34	11.02	9.77
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)			
Net Margin [%]	15.88	15.10	12.92
% LT Debt to Capitalization	26.48	30.93	32.87
Return on Equity [%]	19.01	17.80	14.57

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31										
Per Share Data [USD]	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value	1.98	-0.10	-3.24	-5.18	-6.65	-8.37	5.65	4.08	3.49	6.24
Free Cash Flow	4.45	4.87	3.23	2.54	2.79	2.55	1.41	1.24	1.71	1.40
Earnings	3.91	3.94	2.49	2.06	1.31	0.20	0.71	1.72	1.12	1.26
Earnings [Normalized]	5.34	5.21	3.65	3.24	2.88	2.50	2.20	2.15	1.98	2.01
Dividends	1.92	1.82	1.53	1.32	1.16	1.08	1.04	0.98	0.90	0.64
Payout Ratio [%]	47.73	45.28	56.95	61.57	83.36	388.00	110.00	32.62	58.76	34.24
Prices: High	141.77	142.60	115.14	89.24	74.92	57.76	45.79	51.74	46.50	65.53
Prices: Low	93.25	105.36	61.61	65.50	55.58	38.34	36.00	39.00	35.65	31.64
P/E Ratio: High	26.50	27.40	31.50	27.50	26.00	23.10	20.80	24.10	23.50	32.60
P/E Ratio: Low	17.50	20.20	16.90	20.20	19.30	15.30	16.40	18.10	18.00	15.70
Income Statement Analysis [Million USD]										
Revenue	43,653	43,075	34,608	31,904	30,578	27,390	20,853	20,405	20,247	19,657
Operating Income	8,836	9,218	5,665	4,757	3,838	2,938	3,218	2,962	2,888	2,190
Depreciation + Amortization	3,267	3,538	3,327	3,014	3,278	3,019	1,351	1,427	1,509	1,674
Interest Expense	558.00	533.00	546.00	670.00	826.00	904.00	431.00	163.00	150.00	145.00
Pretax Income	8,306	8,211	4,968	4,077	2,873	2,231	1,413	3,183	2,518	2,041
Effective Tax Rate	16.50	13.90	10.00	9.60	18.80	84.20	24.80	18.10	31.70	2.60
Net Income	6,933	7,071	4,495	3,687	2,368	477.00	1,400	4,423	2,284	2,576
Net Income [Normalized]	5,262	5,459	3,241	2,588	1,918	1,398	1,495	1,870	1,774	1,311
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data [Million USD]										
Cash	10,170	10,249	7,148	4,140	4,086	9,610	18,775	6,125	4,460	8,098
Current Assets	25,224	24,239	20,441	15,667	14,632	20,147	26,776	14,155	13,556	19,247
Total Assets	74,438	75,196	72,548	67,887	67,173	76,250	52,666	41,247	41,207	42,953
Current Liabilities	15,489	13,105	11,907	10,863	9,012	8,912	6,660	9,186	10,467	9,507
Long Term Debt	14,522	17,296	18,527	16,661	19,359	27,210	20,681	5,871	3,393	3,388
Total Capital	54,851	55,275	52,893	50,400	50,288	59,022	42,723	30,327	29,469	31,828
Capital Expenditures	1,777	1,885	2,177	1,638	1,394	1,135	1,121	1,110	1,077	1,145
Cash from Operations	9,581	10,533	7,901	6,136	6,300	5,570	3,203	2,966	3,675	3,324
Current Ratio	1.63	1.85	1.72	1.44	1.62	2.26	4.02	1.54	1.30	2.02
% Long Term Debt of Capitalization	26.50	31.30	35.00	33.10	38.50	46.10	48.40	19.40	11.50	10.60
% Net Income of Revenue	15.90	16.40	13.00	11.60	7.70	1.70	6.70	21.70	11.30	13.10
% Return on Assets	7.38	7.80	5.04	4.40	3.34	2.85	4.28	4.49	4.29	2.48
% Return on Equity	19.00	20.50	13.90	11.90	7.60	1.40	5.10	12.10	7.30	7.60

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Abbott Laboratories**Sub-Industry Outlook**

Our fundamental outlook for the health care equipment [i.e., medical device] sub-industry for the next 12 months is neutral. We anticipate a tailwind from a continued recovery in elective procedures. We also see at-home Covid-19 test sales declining considerably after May 11, 2023, when many Americans stopped receiving free testing, including at-home kits, as well as pharmaceutical Covid-19 treatments. However, from a macroeconomic standpoint, we anticipate easing inflation throughout 2023 and improving supply chains to serve as tailwinds.

On average, we forecast EPS performance will turn a corner and rise 6% in 2023 vs. a 3% decline in 2022. Over the medium term, we expect growth to moderate back toward historical levels as the pandemic reaches an endemic state and elective procedure volumes return to normal levels. Though there may be new Covid-19 variants, we don't expect procedure volumes to decline substantially given the progress made by global vaccine campaigns. Meanwhile, diagnostics companies continue to benefit from the sales of Covid-19 tests, though these sales are declining on a Y/Y basis.

A near-term trend benefiting the industry is strong outpatient care activity, especially care for seniors. For example, there is growth in hip and knee surgeries and related equipment. In the long run, we generally see positive fundamental trends for medical device manufacturers, including increasing global demand for cost-effective value-based health care, aging populations, and rising R&D outlays, which have resulted in a steady flow of innovative products and revenue growth.

The peak of the pandemic was particularly advantageous for medical device companies that were heavily exposed to Covid-19-related sales, and less so for companies exposed to elective procedure volumes. We expect 2023 to be a weaker year for Covid-19 tests sales. In the long run, there will likely still be demand for Covid-19 testing since physicians will require tests for treatment purposes. Also, medical device companies that make products supporting drug

development and distribution efforts, such as Danaher [DHR], have done well during the pandemic, though we anticipate weaker performance to come as demand wanes.

We continue to see little regulatory or legislative risk to the medical device industry, especially after the most recent challenge to the Affordable Care Act [ACA] was dismissed by the Supreme Court.

Meanwhile, the M&A environment appears to be lukewarm, with deal counts down in recent years. However, we think deal counts bottomed in 2022 and will begin to turn a corner in 2023. M&A activity is likely to center on companies looking to take advantage of trends accelerated by the pandemic, such as the adoption of remote monitoring and telehealth.

Starting in 2024, we expect the medical device industry to grow sales in the range of 6%-8% annually, driven by recovering demand, new product sales, growing emerging market exposure, and some Covid-19 test sales. On average, we expect operating margins in 2023-2024 will be slightly higher than 2019 levels [pre-pandemic], particularly for companies heavily exposed to elective procedures.

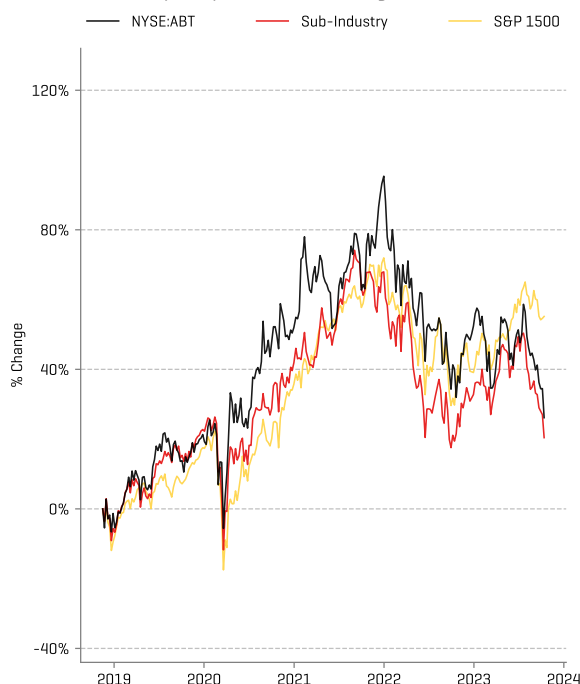
Year to date through August 18, the S&P 1500 Health Care Equipment Index was up 1.1% vs. -2.0% for the Health Care Sector and 13.1% for the S&P 1500 Composite Index. In 2022, the Health Care Equipment Index contracted 20%, the same as the Composite Index; the Health Care Sector fell 3.6% in 2022.

/ **Paige Meyer**

Industry Performance**GICS Sector: Health Care****Sub-Industry: Health Care Equipment**

Based on S&P 1500 Indexes

Five-Year market price performance through Oct 14, 2023



NOTE: A sector chart appears when the sub-industry does not have sufficient historical index data.

All Sector & Sub-Industry information is based on the Global Industry Classification Standard [GICS].

Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.

Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence

Sub-Industry: Health Care Equipment Peer Group*: Health Care Equipment

Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. [M]	30-Day Price Chg. [%]	1-Year Price Chg. [%]	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield [%]	Return on Equity [%]	LTD to Cap [%]
Abbott Laboratories	ABT	NYSE	USD	90.87	157,692.0	-11.5	-11.3	21.0	76.98	2.2	13.9	27.0
Becton, Dickinson and Company	BDX	NYSE	USD	258.70	75,051.0	-2.4	14.2	22.0	229.70	1.4	6.5	34.9
Boston Scientific Corporation	BSX	NYSE	USD	49.52	72,508.0	-6.9	22.7	26.0	33.35	N/A	5.1	30.4
DexCom, Inc.	DXCM	NasdaqGS	USD	76.19	29,552.0	-27.6	-25.1	67.0	64.10	N/A	16.4	44.4
Edwards Lifesciences Corporation	EW	NYSE	USD	70.78	43,028.0	-3.3	-16.0	28.0	68.27	N/A	22.4	8.4
GE HealthCare Technologies Inc.	GEHC	NasdaqGS	USD	67.12	30,529.0	4.0	N/A	19.0	37.09	0.2	15.3	57.1
IDEXX Laboratories, Inc.	IDXX	NasdaqGS	USD	426.18	35,378.0	-7.0	27.1	45.0	429.02	N/A	102.1	31.1
Intuitive Surgical, Inc.	ISRG	NasdaqGS	USD	273.15	95,973.0	-9.8	43.5	54.0	217.40	N/A	12.0	N/A
Medtronic plc	MDT	NYSE	USD	71.96	95,745.0	-11.5	-13.8	13.0	70.02	3.8	7.0	32.0
STERIS plc	STE	NYSE	USD	222.32	21,961.0	-3.5	31.2	185.0	N/A	0.9	1.9	30.8
Stryker Corporation	SYK	NYSE	USD	257.88	97,937.0	-13.3	20.4	26.0	226.17	1.2	16.4	36.2

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.

NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.

Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Abbott Laboratories

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

July 20, 2023

01:02 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT 111.65****]:

We maintain our 12-month target of \$130, reflecting 28.1x our '24 EPS estimate, a premium to ABT's historical forward average due to a strong long-term growth outlook. We widen our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.01 to \$4.40 and trim 2024's by \$0.32 to \$4.63. Q2 adj. EPS of \$1.08 vs. \$1.43, was \$0.03 above consensus driven by strong sales from the Medical Devices segment, particularly the Diabetes Care (+19.4% Y/Y) and Neuromodulation (+15.1%) businesses. In Q2, the Freestyle Libre became the only continuous glucose monitoring system to be nationally reimbursed in France for all people with diabetes using insulin. Neuromodulation sales growth was driven by the launch of Eterna, ABT's first rechargeable neurostimulation device for pain management, which targets a large segment of the market where ABT previously did not compete. We forecast Q3 Covid testing sales of \$100M, down Q/Q due to the end of the public health emergency in May, though we anticipate higher organic base business EPS growth than previously expected. / Paige Meyer

April 19, 2023

02:19 PM ET... CFRA Reiterates Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT 112.23****]:

We raise our 12-month target price by \$9 to \$130 based on a 29.6x multiple of our 2023 EPS forecast, in line with peers. We lift our 2023 EPS estimate by \$0.02 to \$4.39 and our 2024 estimate by \$0.07 to \$4.95. ABT posts Q1 adjusted EPS of \$1.03 versus \$1.73, beating the S&P Capital IQ consensus estimate by \$0.05, driven by robust performance by the Medical Devices segment. Within this segment, ABT reported double-digit organic growth Y/Y in Diabetes Care, Structural Heart, Heart Failure, and Neuromodulation, driven by recently launched products and new indications. In addition, ABT also posted a continued recovery in U.S. Nutrition following the voluntary recall of certain infant formula products last year and subsequent resumption of production. We see lower Covid testing sales for the remainder of 2023 than expected previously, offset by higher expectations for base business growth. / Paige Meyer

January 25, 2023

01:43 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT 110.41****]:

We lift our 12 month target price by \$11 to \$121, 27.7x our 2023 EPS estimate, a premium to ABT's historical forward average. We narrow our 2023 EPS estimate to \$4.37 from \$4.85 and initiate our 2024 estimate at \$4.88. ABT reports Q4 adjusted EPS of \$1.03 vs. \$1.32, exceeding the S&P Capital IQ consensus estimate by \$0.10. Sales of \$10.1 billion in the quarter exceeded consensus expectations by 4%, albeit down Y/Y due to lower Covid-19-related testing sales, given strong performance in the Established Pharmaceuticals and Medical Device divisions. Medical Device sales growth was driven by Diabetes Care and Structural Heart products. In 2023, we forecast organic sales growth, excluding Covid-19-related testing sales and FX impacts, in the high-single digits. We also forecast \$2 billion of Covid-19 testing sales, down from \$8.4 billion in 2022, as Covid-19 transitions to more of an endemic seasonal type of respiratory virus. / Paige Meyer

October 19, 2022

02:53 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT 98.00****]:

We drop our 12-mo. target to \$110 from \$123, 21x our 2024 EPS estimate [started at \$5.26; 2023 dropped to \$4.85 from \$5.17; 2022 raised to \$5.19 from \$4.95. Our valuation multiple is below ABT's pre-pandemic 2018-2019 forward P/E average of 23x, reflecting the impact of rising interest rates on equity valuations as well as higher than usual forecasting uncertainty given rising risk of recession. Q3 adjusted EPS of \$1.15 beat consensus by \$0.21. Q3 revenue fell 5% Y/Y, with a large negative impact to Diagnostics [35% of sales, -6% Y/Y] from waning Covid-19 diagnostics sales. Nutrition [17%, -15% Y/Y] also saw a sharp decline due to the manufacturing stoppage for baby formula products, although production resumed in Q3. We expect ABT sales to fall 4% in 2023 as annual Covid-19 testing-related sales of \$7.8 billion drop to under \$2.0 billion by our estimate. But we see growth of 5% Y/Y in 2024, driven in large part by stand-out glucose monitoring technology within the medical devices segment [35% of sales]. / Colin Scarola

July 20, 2022

05:21 PM ET... CFRA Reiterates Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT

108.00****]:

We drop our 12-month target to \$123 from \$142, 24x our 2023 EPS estimate [raised to \$5.17 from \$5.12; 2022 to \$4.95 from \$4.84] -- in line with ABT's 5-year forward P/E average. Q2 EPS of \$1.43 (+22% Y/Y) beat consensus by \$0.29. Q2 revenue grew 10% Y/Y, handily beating consensus of +2% Y/Y on exceptionally strong performance in Diagnostics [38% of sales, +33% Y/Y]. This was driven by continued robust demand for rapid testing products, especially Covid-19 tests, although management expects Covid-19 testing sales will fall sharply in H2. Outside of Diagnostics, ABT saw strong organic growth of 9% Y/Y in Established Pharmaceuticals, which we see continuing to grow at healthy rates through 2023, helping to offset tapering Covid-19-related sales. ABT also received FDA breakthrough device designation in June on its glucose-ketone bio-wearable sensor, which we think has the potential to be a long-term growth driver. We continue to think ABT shares are attractively valued relative to long-term growth potential. / Colin Scarola

April 20, 2022

10:31 AM ET... CFRA Reiterates Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT 122.08****]:

We lift our 12-month target price by \$2 to \$142, a 29.3x multiple of our '22 EPS estimate, a premium to ABT's historical forward average. We lift our '22 EPS estimate to \$4.84 from \$4.75 and narrow our '23 estimate to \$5.12 from \$5.17. Q1 EPS of \$1.73 vs. \$1.32 beat the consensus estimate by \$0.27, driven by exceptionally strong performance in the U.S. Diagnostics business, led by sales of rapid testing products, and with Y/Y growth in the Established Pharmaceuticals (EPD) and Medical Devices businesses, partially offset by a decline in Nutrition. We see global growth in organic sales of Nutrition products Ensure, Glucerna, Pediasure, and Pedialyte helping offset some of the lost sales from the voluntary recall of infant formula products manufactured at one U.S. facility while ABT works with the FDA and CDC to move past the recall. We anticipate EPD will continue to achieve double-digit organic sales growth throughout 2022, with strong performance in gastroenterology, respiratory, and pain management. / Paige Meyer

January 26, 2022

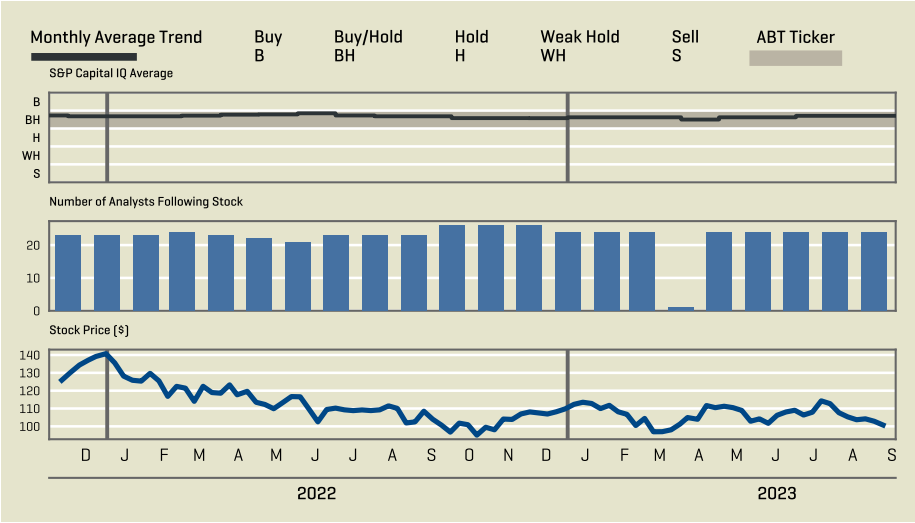
02:59 PM ET... CFRA Keeps Buy Opinion on Shares of Abbott Laboratories [ABT 120.81****]:

We narrow our 12-month target price by \$1 to \$140, reflecting 29.5x our 2022 EPS estimate, a premium to ABT's historical forward average. We narrow our 2022 EPS estimate to \$4.75 from \$5.06 and initiate our 2023 estimate at \$5.17. ABT closes out 2021 with Q4 EPS of \$1.32 vs. \$1.45, \$0.11 above the S&P Capital IQ consensus view, driven by strong performance in the Medical Devices business segment, particularly for Diabetes Care and Heart Failure products. We anticipate strong Covid testing demand at the start of the year due to the Omicron variant; the company's initial guidance for Covid testing sales starts at \$2.5 billion, though we anticipate potential upward revisions to the estimate as the pandemic evolves. In 2022, we forecast organic sales growth for ABT's base business, excluding COVID tests, in the high single digits, aided by projects such as the Libre 3 launch globally. / Paige Meyer

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

Abbott Laboratories

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo. Prior	3 Mos. Prior
Buy	12	50	12	12
Buy/Hold	5	21	5	5
Hold	7	29	7	7
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	0
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	24	100	24	24

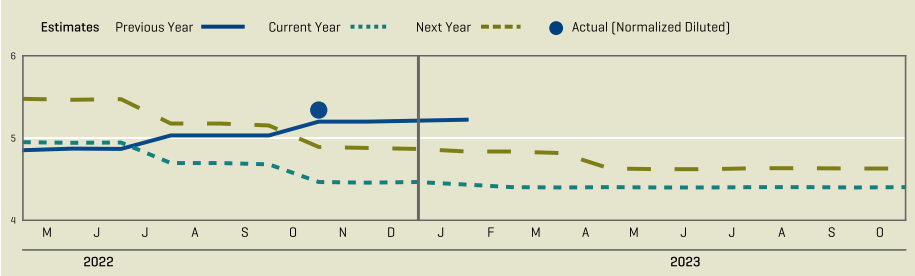
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that ABT will earn USD 4.40. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that ABT's earnings per share will grow by 5.15% to USD 4.63.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	4.63	4.88	4.52	22	19.63
2023	4.40	4.47	4.32	22	20.64
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 5%	▲ 9%	▲ 5%	N/A%	▼ -5%
Q3'24	1.18	1.24	1.15	9	76.92
Q3'23	1.10	1.12	1.06	20	82.78
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	▲ 8%	▲ 11%	▲ 9%	▼ -55%	▼ -7%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Abbott Laboratories

Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsule the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



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Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

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Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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